One sentence on a website can cost a small firm $75,000

01 · It goes up

"no conflicts of interest"

One adviser's website said this, word for word.

→

02 · Nobody reads it

8

Employees at the median SEC-registered adviser. No one's job is reading every page.

→

03 · The SEC reads it

$75,000

The SEC's fine for that one sentence, Sept 2025.

Today the only check is **a person with a search box**, and AI-written posts keep adding pages for them to read.

> "I put the name of the firm into a search … news today."
>
> Sense interviewee, on a check they run by hand every week

Not legal advice. All flags require human review.

vigil

So we built Vigil to read every page before an examiner does

01

It finds the pages

The firm's own site, plus pages other people wrote about it.

`Bright Data search`

02

It saves them

A screenshot and a dated copy each time a page changes.

`Screenshot + hash`

03

It reads them

Every sentence, for meaning. If it can't quote the page exactly, it doesn't flag.

`8 rule categories`

04

A person decides

The officer approves, edits or dismisses each flag, and it's all logged.

`Audit log`

11 / 11

On our fictional demo firm, it found every planted issue with 0 false alarms.

9 of 11 at first; we fixed both misses on this site. One run, not real-world accuracy.

Not legal advice. All flags require human review.

Then we showed testers, and their worries shaped it

> "repeatedly … having false positives"

So we kept precision first

28% → 0%

Clean docs wrongly flagged (5 of 18 → 0 of 18)

> "people continue to use new words"

So it reads for meaning, not keywords

0.70 → 0.98

F1 score (issues caught 15/21 → 21/21)

> "not a sample … to illustrate a misleading advertisement"

So it skips examples and quoted rules

2/2 → 0/2

Examples wrongly flagged; the firm's own claim still caught

They also asked for three things Vigil already did:

Find the ad again

Screenshot, capture time and a live link on every flag.

See pages about the firm

7 of 7 third-party pages found, 0 personal pages.

Keep a human in charge

The officer approves or dismisses every flag, and it's logged.

Keyword rules → Vigil. One run each, on synthetic cases we wrote. Third-party search is simulated. Not legal advice.